

ART & CULTURE



INDIAN PAINTINGS

MODULE - 6

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

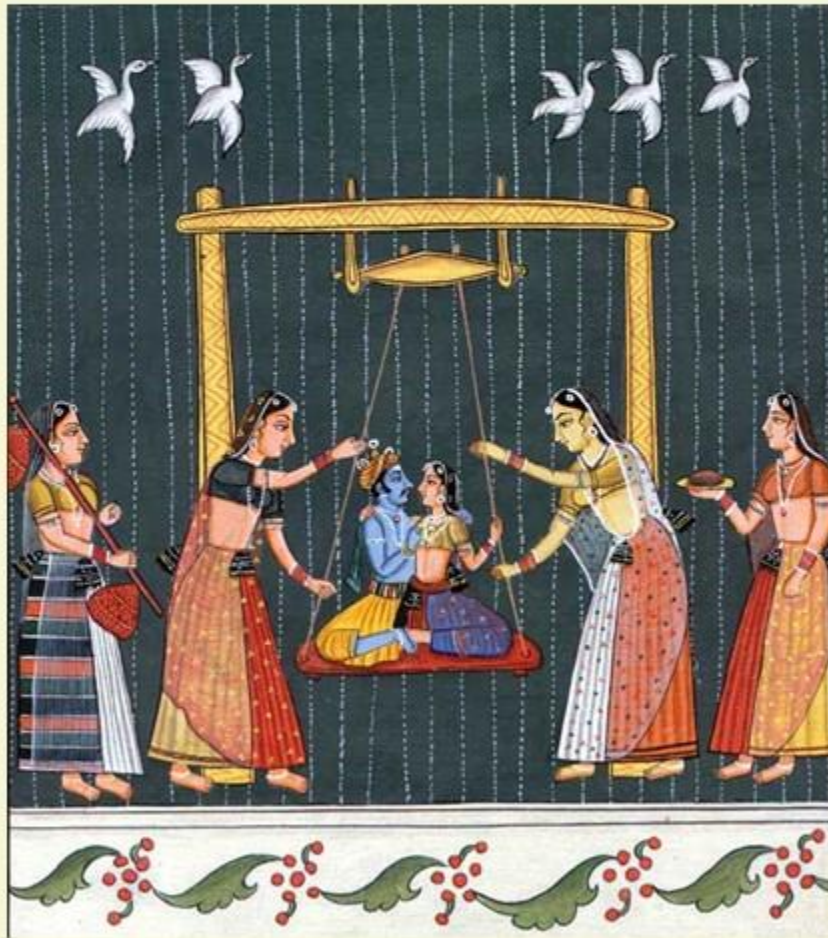
VARIOUS SCHOOLS OF MINIATURE PAINTINGS

- 1) The Pala School
- 2) Western Indian School
- 3) Other Isolated Styles
- 4) The Mughal School
- 5) The Deccani School
 - a) Ahmednagar
 - b) Bijapur
 - c) Golkonda
 - d) Hyderabad
 - e) Tanjore
- 6) The Central India and Rajasthani school
 - a) Malwa
 - b) Mewar
 - c) Bundi
 - d) Kota
 - e) Amber-Jaipur
 - f) Marwar
 - g) Bikaner
 - h) Kishangarh
- 7) The Pahari School
 - a) Basholi
 - b) Guler
 - c) Kangra
 - d) Kulu-Mandi
- 8) The Orissa School

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

6. d)

AMBER-JAIPUR SCHOOL



- 1 The Amber rulers were another dynasty that was closely associated with the Mughals.
- 2 It is known that they were major patrons and avid collectors of painting, yet the identity of an “Amber School” is not as well etched in our minds as that of other schools. Much of the collection has remained in private hands and is unpublished.
- 3 The Amber school is also called the “Dhundar” school and their earliest evidences come from the wall paintings at Bairat in Rajasthan.

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

6. d)

AMBER-JAIPUR SCHOOL



4 Dhundhar is a historical region of Rajasthan state in western India. It includes the districts of Jaipur, Sawai Madhopur and Tonk.

5 The paintings of Amber style show strong Mughal influence.

6 Frescoes in the Amber style may be noticed in Mughal garden of Bairath, in which themes like raag-ragini, Krishna-Lila, elephant riding, horse riding and camel riding were painted.

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

6. d)

AMBER-JAIPUR SCHOOL



7 Some paintings can also be seen from the palace walls and mausoleum of Ajmer palace in Rajasthan.

8 Even though some of the menfolk are shown wearing Mughal style clothing and headgear, the overall finish of the paintings is folk-styled.

9 This styled reached its zenith in the period of Sawai Pratap Singh in the 18th century.

10 He was a deeply religious man and passionate patron of art. These two strains combined to ensure that his suratkhana or the department of painting made miniatures to illustrate Bhagwata Purana, Ramyana, Ragamala and several portraits.

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

6. e) MARWAR SCHOOL OF PAINTINGS



- 1 It is one of the most extensive schools of painting as it includes **Jodhpur and Bikaner**, both ruled by the Rathods and **Jaisalmer** that was ruled by the Bhatias.
- 2 Like Bikaner, Jodhpur too was a desert kingdom that prospered through its close links with Mughals.
- 3 In the paintings produced in the 15th and 16th century, the men wore colourful clothing and so did the women.

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

6. e) MARWAR SCHOOL OF PAINTINGS



4 In this period, they followed the Mughal patterns but after the 18th century the Rajput element became predominant

5 The Jodhpur atelier has many brilliant paintings but the focus has always been on the extraordinary paintings in the time of Man Singh (1803-1843) and after.

6 He commissioned extensive series of paintings including the Shiva Purana, Natacharitra, Durgacharitra, Panchatantra etc.

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

6. f)

BIKANER SCHOOL OF PAINTING

- 1 One of the earliest Rajput States to forge an alliance with the Mughals, Bikaner prospered greatly from this partnership, and the 16th-18th centuries saw a great efflorescence of courtly arts
- 2 The Bikaner rulers built ornate and exquisite palaces and amassed a large collection of miniature paintings, from Mughal, Deccani and other Rajput schools and also established a large atelier of their own.
- 3 Early paintings from Bikaner were made by “**Patshahi Chitrakars**” émigré artists from the Mughal court, and their work is hard to distinguish from Mughal ones.
- 4 We can see the works of Patshahi and desi Chitrakars in the light of the extraordinary archival material surviving in Bikaner

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

7. a) PAHARI STYLES OF PAINTING

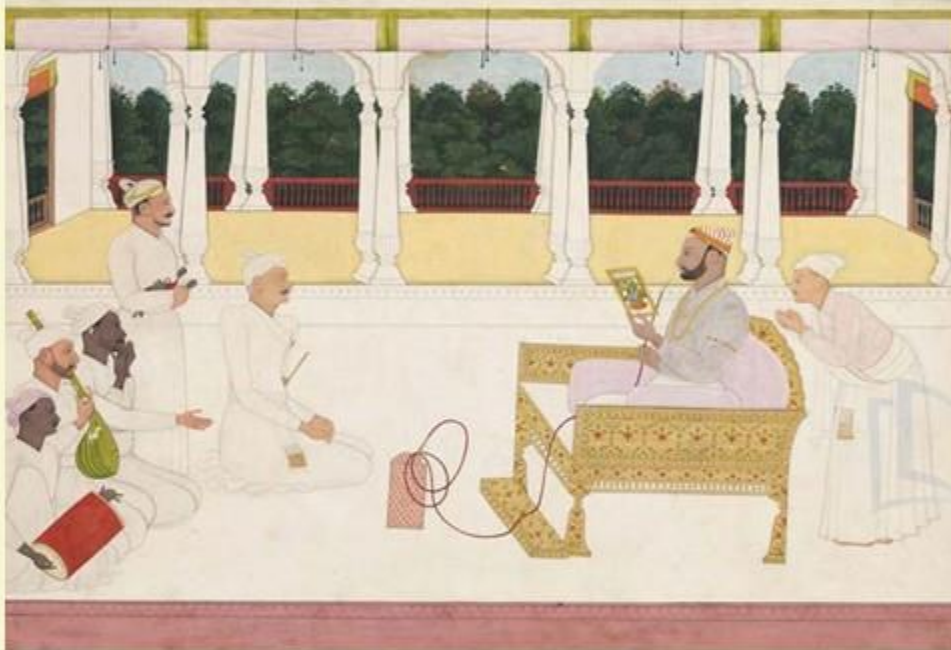
- 1 This style of painting developed in the **sub-Himalayan States** that were also under the umbrella of Mughal over lordship.



- 2 The **paintings** were very naturalistic and used **strong colours** and **facial appearances** show variations from **region to region**.
- 3 There were many schools that were flourishing in smaller kingdoms, which came under the blanket of "**Pahari Paintings**".
- 4 These consisted ateliers of around 22 princely states stretching from Jammu to Almora. Hence, the Pahari Paintings can be grouped into two groups:
 - Jammu and Dogra School: Northern Series
 - Kangra School: Southern Series

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

7. a) PAHARI STYLES OF PAINTING



**Raja Balwant Singh viewing a painting,
with Nainsukh behind him**

- 5** The themes that were painted ranged from Mythology like the Hindu epics, puranas to literary works such as the Gita Govinda and brought new techniques to the fore.
- 6** A typical Pahari painting would bring several figures into the canvas and they would all be full of movement.
- 7** Each figure is different in composition, colour and pigmentation. Two of the greatest figures of this school are Nainsukh and Manaku.

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

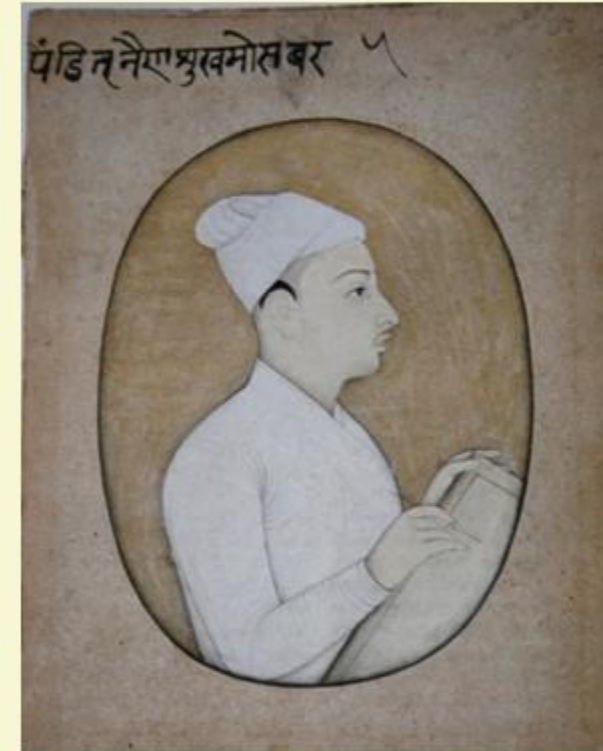
7. a)

PAHARI STYLES OF PAINTING

PAINTINGS OF NAINSUKH



Raja Dhruv Dev assesses a horse; it was usual for horses to be shown off in front of a white sheet, to better appreciate their form



Self-portrait at the age of 20

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

7. b)

BASHOLI SCHOOL



Lord Ganesha of
Basohli school

- 1 The paintings created in the Pahari School in the 17th Century were called the Basholi School.
- 2 This was the early phase and expressive faces with a receding hairline and big eyes that are shaped like lotus petals characterize it.
- 3 These paintings use a lot of primary colors i.e red, yellow and green. They used the Mughal technique of painting on clothing but developed their own styles and techniques.

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

7. b)

BASHOLI SCHOOL



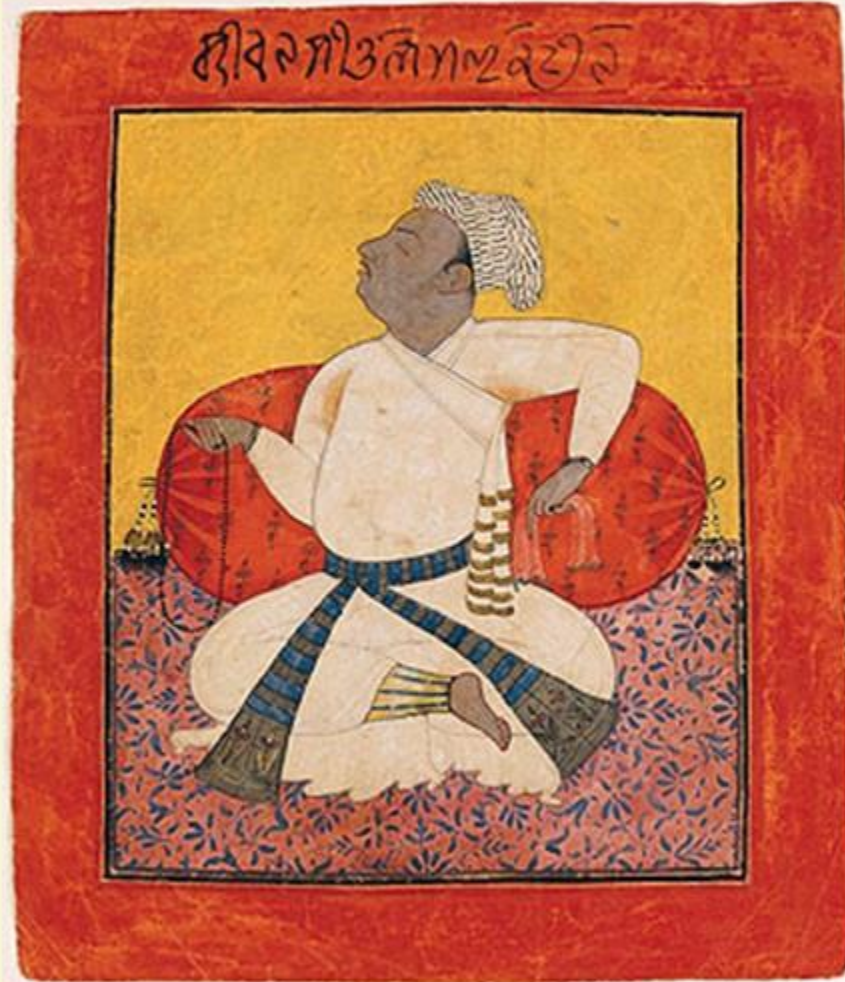
Radha and Krishna in Discussion (An illustration from Gita Govinda)

- 4 The first patron of this school was **Raja Kirpal Singh** who ordered the illustration of **Bhanudatta's Rasamanjari, Gita Govinda** and the **Ramayana** drawings.
- 5 The most famous painter of this school was **Devi Das** who was famous for his depiction of **Radha Krishna** and the portrait of kings in their royal attire.
- 6 The contrast of colours is associated with this school and they stylistically borrowed from the Malwa paintings.

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7. b)

BASHOLI SCHOOL



Maharaja Sital Dev of Mankot in Devotion



Raja Amrit Pal of Basohli

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

7. c)

KANGRA SCHOOL

- 1 Kangra painting is the pictorial art of Kangra, a former princely state in Himachal Pradesh, which patronized the art.



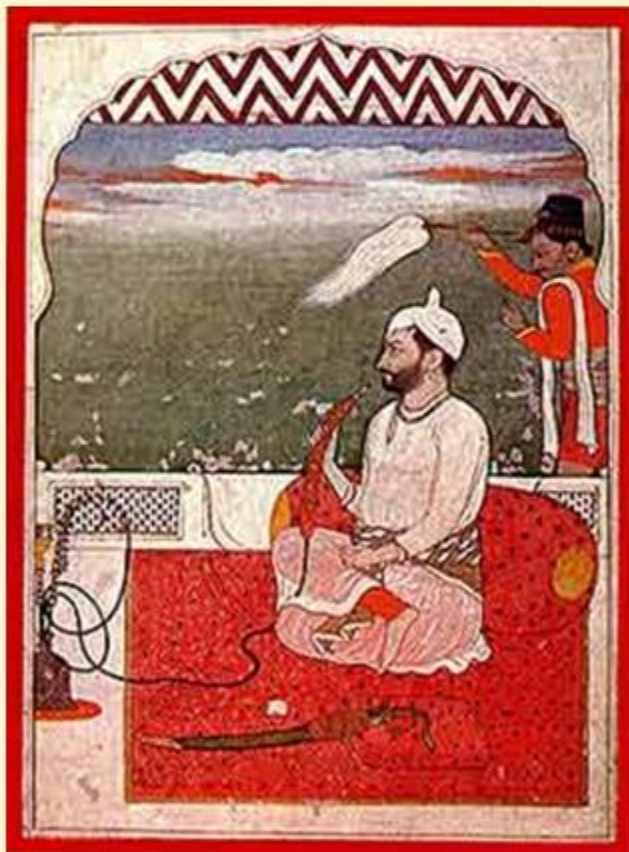
- 2 It became predominant with the fading of Basholi school of painting in mid-18th century, and soon produced such a magnitude in paintings both in content as well as volume, that the Pahari painting school, came to be known as Kangra paintings.
- 3 After the decline of Mughal Empire many artists trained in the Mughal style migrated to the Kangra region as they got patronage by Raja Goverdhan Singh in 1774.
- 4 It led to the birth of Guler-Kangra School of paintings. It first evolved in Guler then came Kangra.

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

7. c)

KANGRA SCHOOL

- 5 This school reached its zenith under the patronage of **Raja Sansar Chand**.



Raja Sansar Chand

- 6 His paintings were marked with **sensuality and intelligence** that the other schools lack. He was the most renowned Raja in the Kangra Valley and was the most generous patron of the art of painting.

- 7 The most popular subjects were the **Gita Govinda, Bhagwata Purana, Satasai of Biharilal** and romantic tale of **Nala Damyanti**.

- 8 The recurring theme of Kangra painting whether it portrays various seasons or modes of music, Radha and Krishna or Siva and Parvati is the **love of man for woman and of woman for man**.

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

7. c)

KANGRA SCHOOL



“Twelve Months”- Chaitra month

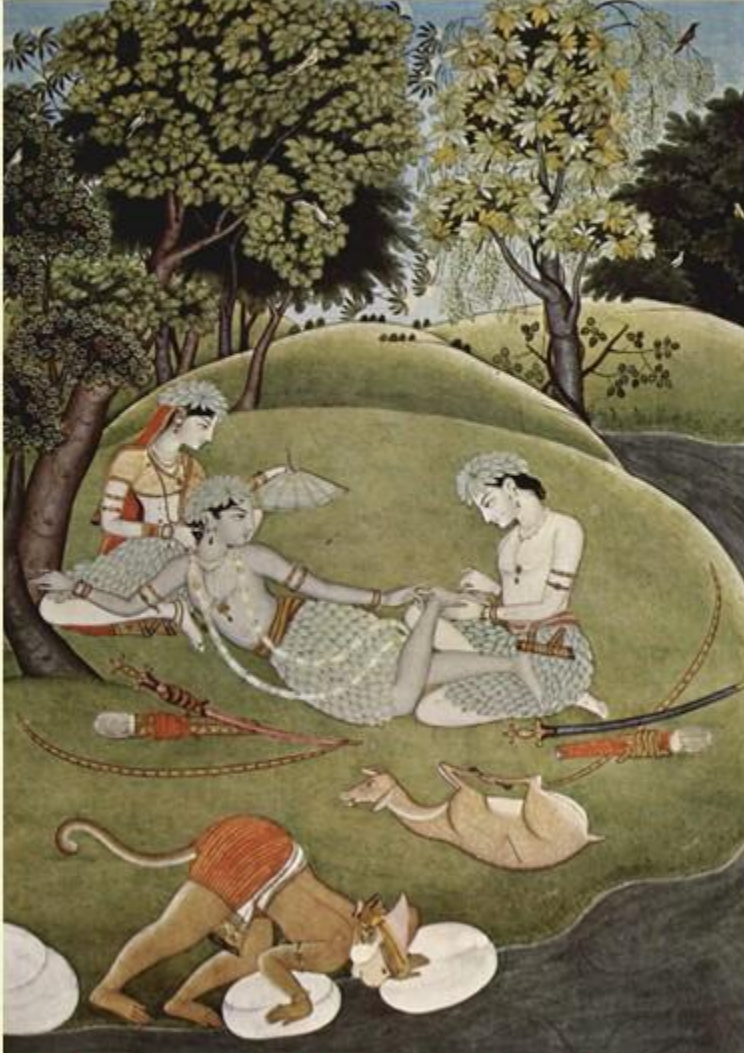
9 All the paintings had an other worldly feel about them. Another very famous group of paintings is the “**Twelve Months**” where the artist tried to bring forth the effect of the twelve months on the emotions of human beings.

10 This emotive style was popular till the 19th century. The Kangra school became the parent school to the other ateliers which developed in the court of Kullu, Chamba and Mandi.

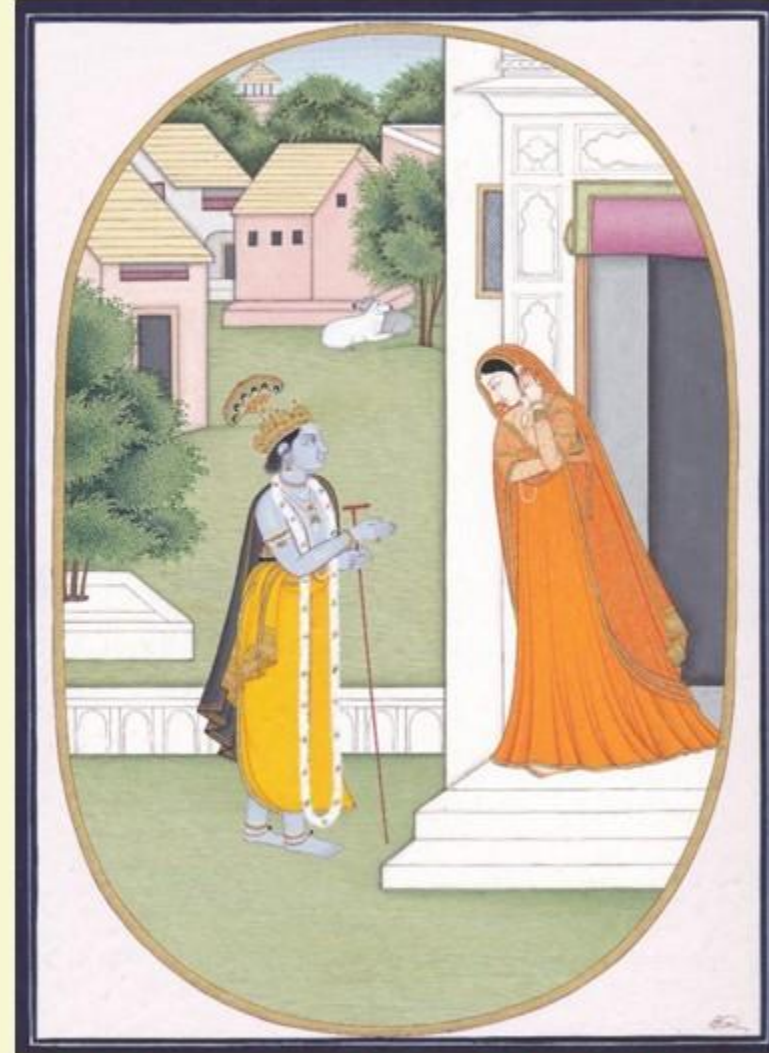
MINIATURE PAINTINGS

7. c)

KANGRA SCHOOL

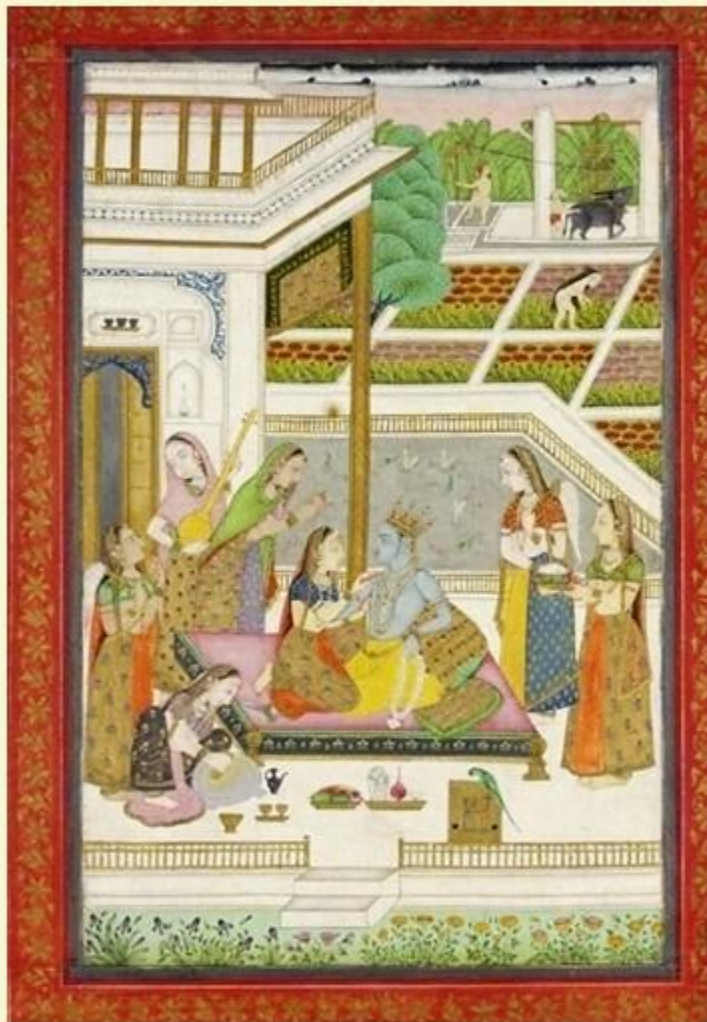


Rama and Sita in the forest



"Message of eyes" painting

A QUICK LOOK AT RAGAMALA PAINTINGS...



Radha-Krishna, a depiction
of Bhairava Raga

- 1 Ragamala Paintings are a series of illustrative paintings from medieval India based on Ragamala or the “Garland of Ragas”, depicting various Indian musical Ragas.
- 2 They stand as a classical example of the amalgamation of art, poetry and classical music in medieval India.
- 3 Ragamala paintings were created in most schools of India painting, starting in 16th and 17th centuries and are today named accordingly, as Pahari Ragamala, Rajasthan or Rajput Ragamala, Deccan Ragamala and Mughal Ragamala.

A QUICK LOOK AT RAGAMALA PAINTINGS...



Hindola Raga painting

- 4 In these painting each raga is personified by a color, mood, a verse describing story of a hero and heroine. It also elucidates the season and the time of day and night in which a particular raga is to be sung.
- 5 Moreover, many paintings also demarcate the specific Hindu deities attached with the raga, like Bhairava or Bhairavi to Shiva and Sri to Devi.
- 6 The six principal ragas present in the Ragamala are **Bhairava**, **Dipika**, **Sri**, **Malkaunsa**, **Megha** and **Hindola** and these are meant to be sung during the six seasons of the year – summer, monsoon, autumn, early winter, winter and spring.

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THE DECCANI SCHOOLS



- 1 Deccani schools flourished in the centres of **Bijapur, Ahmedabad and Golconda** in the 16th and 17th century CE.
- 2 Initially, the style of painting of these centres was independent of Mughal style, **but later period paintings have increasing Mughal influence.**

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THE DECCANI SCHOOLS

a

AHMEDNAGAR STYLE



- 1 The volume of poems written by **Hussain Nizam Shah I of Ahmednagar** (1553-1565) is contained in a manuscript **Tarif-i-Hussain Shahi**.
- 2 This is an **illustrated manuscript** and is the earliest example of this style of painting.
- 3 The use of colours (such as golden sky) is rich and brilliant and has a distinct Persian influence.

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THE DECCANI SCHOOLS

b

BIJAPUR STYLE



- 1 This style of painting was patronized by **Adil Shah I** (1550-80 CE) and his successors.
- 2 The document **Najum-Al-Ulum** (**Stars of Sciences**) was illustrated by nearly 876 miniatures.
- 3 The paintings have influences of **Lepakshi mural paintings** (as seen in the dress and appearances of the ladies) as well as **Persian influence** (evident in the Arabesque design and use of golden colour).

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THE DECCANI SCHOOLS

c

GOLCONDA STYLE



- 1 This style flourished during the reign of **Quli Qutab Shah** (1580-1611).
- 2 The paintings **usually contain court scenes.**
- 3 The style of painting absorbed the traditions of **Vijayanagar style** as well as the influences of the **Mughal style.**

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THE DECCANI SCHOOLS

d

HYDERABAD STYLE



Guru Darshan painting

- 1 The painting style flourished during the reign of **Asaf-Jahi dynasty** (founded by **Nizam-ul-Mulk** in 1724 AD).
- 2 The paintings include court scenes and portraits.
- 3 They were rich in colour and appearance.
- 4 Its distinctive features were observed in the treatment in paintings, of costumes, jewellery, colours, landscape, flora-fauna etc.

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